

UNIT 3: THE ALTERNATIVES

Class Time: 75 Minutes

Description

This unit will examine the growing movement of fair trade and ethical consumerism. The lesson begins with the presentation of student posters on MNCs that were assigned in Unit 1 (See Activity 6: Backstage of a Multi-National Corporation). Your student will go on a corporate tour of some of the world's mega corporations. At the end of the tour, have your students participate in a round of "the Clothes on your Back" (See Activity 7), a popular activity in the NGO community. The lesson will conclude by taking a closer look at the jeans industry and following the production of a pair of brand name jeans and a pair of organic jeans from the cotton plantation to the consumer (See Activity 8).

Curriculum Expectations

Backstage of a Multi-National Corporation (Homework)

Overall Expectations

GCV.01 – demonstrate an understanding of the interdependence of countries in the global economy.

GCV.02 – analyse instances of international cooperation and conflict and identify factors that contribute to each.

Specific Expectations

HE2.06 – explain ways in which trade policies or agreements may affect the environment.

GC3.02 – evaluate the performance of a selected transnational corporation with respect to the promotion of environmental sustainability and human rights.

The Clothes on your Back

Specific Expectation

UC3.01 – identify awareness levels and viewpoints relating to a geographic issue by conducting a survey in the school or local community.

Cotton to Consumer

Overall Expectation

UCV.03 – evaluate the effectiveness of methods used by different organizations, governments, and industries to find short- and long-term solutions to geographic problems and issues at the local, national, and global level.

Specific Expectation

HE2.06 – explain ways in which trade policies or agreements may affect the environment.

GC3.01 – demonstrate an understanding of how quality of life and employment prospects are related to the global economy.

GC3.04 – evaluate factors that may compound problems of hunger and poverty in a selected country.

UC1.02 – explain how local participation in the development process can build sustainable communities.

UC2.03 – evaluate the role played by NGOs and local community initiatives in different parts of the world in promoting sustainable development and resource management.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

- Awareness of the fair trade movement.
- Some knowledge of sweatshop characteristics.
- Group work.

Planning Notes

- You will need tape to display your student's posters on the wall for Activity 6.
- Bring enough post-it notes (small size) for each student to have 5 sheets.
- Photocopy the Wage Sheet (See Supplementary Sheet 9).
- Photocopy 1 set of "Cotton to Consumer" cards for each group (4 people/group) and out each card. Mix them all up and put an elastic around each set (See Supplementary Sheet 10).
- Photocopy the Fair Trade Fact sheet for your students (See Fair Trade Fact sheet).
- Review the glossary of terms and be prepared to define any for the class.

Teaching/Learning Strategies

Most of the learning strategies are described in each activity, but here are some of the overall strategies for the unit.

- Introduce students to the concept of the global economy.
- Examine the historical path of globalisation by identifying the policies and international commitments and the effects of the implementation of local, national, and global issues.
- Identify individuals who have made a significant contribution to globalisation.
- Introduce the students to new vocabulary and the new concepts listed in each activity. Refer them to the glossary.
- Refer the students to the accompanying material, the supplementary sheets, and where to go find information.
- Assign students the suggested homework and encourage students to do an in-depth analysis of the information provided and to research the websites given.
- Monitor the group work and simulation games so the benefits are maximized for your students.

Accommodations

Frequent monitoring and assistance should be provided. Accommodations that are normally provided in the regular classroom for students with special needs should be provided. Here are some strategies for helping them.

- Information should be presented in as many modalities as possible through oral presentations, board notes, diagrams, class discussions, activity-based learning.
- Instructions should be clear, concise, to the point, verbally rehearsed by the student, properly sequenced, reviewed after a time lapse, written down on the board or in a notebook.
- Assignments should be outlined in writing, written in the students' homework/assignment book, written (and left) on the blackboard, broken down step by step with the teacher, rehearsed/modelled, and scheduled step by step.
- Questioning should be clear, concise, allowing for appropriate response time. Students need to organise their thoughts, match them with appropriate vocabulary, put them in correct syntax, sequence the ideas and finally express them with good speech. These skills are often taken for granted when teaching new concepts.
- Encourage students to question for clarification and additional information. Learn to speak at a lower rate of speech. Avoid figurative language unless it has been specifically pre-taught. Encourage and evaluate oral responses and class participation. Allow extra time (e.g. homework) for students to complete assignments that other students may finish in class time.

Create extra practice opportunities with new vocabulary or concepts. Provide overviews or lesson highlights at the beginning of class. Discuss and simplify sophisticated vocabulary or language. Finally, give several short assignments rather than one long one.